

EQ Prerequisite: Environmental Tobacco Smoke Control

This prerequisite applies to

- ▶ BD+C: New Construction
- ▶ BD+C: Core & Shell
- ▶ BD+C: Schools
- ▶ BD+C: Retail
- ▶ BD+C: Data Centers
- ▶ BD+C: Warehouses & Distribution Centers
- ▶ BD+C: Hospitality
- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare

INTENT

To prevent or minimize exposure of building occupants, indoor surfaces, and ventilation air distribution systems to environmental tobacco smoke.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, RETAIL, DATA CENTERS, WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS, HOSPITALITY, HEALTHCARE

For this prerequisite smoking includes tobacco smoke, as well as smoke produced from the combustion of cannabis and controlled substances and the emissions produced by electronic smoking devices.

Prohibit smoking inside the building.

Prohibit smoking outside the building except in designated smoking areas located at least 25 feet (7.5 meters) (or the maximum extent allowable by local codes) from all entries, outdoor air intakes, and operable windows.

Communicate the no-smoking policy to occupants. Have in place provisions for enforcement or no-smoking signage.

Residential only

Option 1. No Smoking

Meet the requirements above.

OR

Option 2. Compartmentalization of Smoking Areas

Meet the requirements above for all areas inside and outside the building except dwelling units and private balconies.

Each dwelling unit where smoking is permitted must be compartmentalized to prevent excessive leakage between units:

- ▶ Weather-strip all exterior doors and operable windows in the residential units to minimize leakage from outdoors.
- ▶ Weather-strip all doors leading from residential units into common hallways.
- ▶ Minimize uncontrolled pathways for the transfer of smoke and other indoor air pollutants between residential units by sealing penetrations in the walls, ceilings, and floors and by sealing vertical chases (including utility chases, garbage chutes, mail drops, and elevator shafts) adjacent to the units.

- ▶ Demonstrate a maximum leakage of 0.30 cubic feet per minute per square foot (1.53 liters per second per square meter) at 50 Pa of enclosure (i.e., all surfaces enclosing the apartment, including exterior and party walls, floors, and ceilings). Renovation projects that retain their existing envelope must meet an allowable maximum leakage of 0.50 cfm50 per square foot (2.54 liters per second per square meter) of enclosure area.

SCHOOLS

Prohibit smoking on site.

Communicate the no-smoking policy to occupants. Have in place provisions for enforcement or no-smoking signage.

GUIDANCE

Refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following additions and modifications:

Behind the Intent

Beta Update

Newer changes to this prerequisite include a revised formal definition of smoking that aligns with industry best practice and incorporates previous related LEED interpretations. In response to feedback from project teams with unique no-smoking enforcement methods, requirements for communicating a no-smoking policy have also been revised and projects can use other means of enforcement beyond signage, and signage location is no longer required to be within 10 feet of the building entrances.

The following language has been moved from the credit requirements to the reference guide: “Also prohibit smoking outside the property line in spaces used for business purposes.”

Step-by-Step Guidance

Step 1. Determine Smoke-Free Locations:

Obtain information from the owner that smoking is prohibited inside the building. Residential projects may allow smoking in specific units, with specific requirements for ensuring that those units are adequately isolated (Refer to the *LEED v4 reference guide, Further Explanation, Project Type Variations*).

- ▶ Identify the location of building openings, including entries, outdoor air intakes, and operable windows.
- ▶ Emergency exits do not qualify as building openings if the doors are alarmed, because alarmed doors will not be opened. Emergency exits without alarms qualify as building openings.

Step 2. Designate Locations of Exterior Smoking Areas:

Determine whether the project has or will have designated outdoor smoking areas. Locate any area designated for smoking at least 25 feet (7.5 meters) from smoke free areas, based on the information gathered in step 1. The 25-foot (7.5 meter) distance is a straight line calculation. Research local codes applicable to the building- the code regulations may or may not meet the 25 feet distance rule for exterior smoking. See the *LEED v4 reference guide, further explanation, code limitations and restrictions*.

- ▶ Consider design strategies that may encourage people to use the designated smoking area, such as covered seating
- ▶ Educate occupants on the smoking policy and encourage them to self-police. This is particularly important in retail situations.
- ▶ Ashtrays signal that smoking is allowed in a particular area. Be sure these are placed outside the 25-foot (7.5 meter) perimeter.

Step 3: Determine Locations of No Smoking Signage:

Communicate no smoking policy proactively to occupants at regular time periods. While the 10 feet of all building entrances rule for posting of signage/no smoking policy is no longer required, it is required

to communicate the no smoking policy to occupants and have in place provisions for either enforcement of the no smoking policy or posting of no smoking signage near all the building entrances.

Tips for good signage include drawings, photos or signage with language communicating clearly interior and exterior no smoking policy, or explicit language such as 'no smoking allowed within xx feet' and 'smoking is allowed in designated smoking areas only' and indicate on signage what those areas are etc.

Further Explanation

Property Line Less Than 25 Feet (7.5 Meters) From the Building:

Projects with a property line less than 25 feet (7.5 meters) from the building must consider space usage when determining the outdoor smoking policy. Smoking must still be prohibited on sidewalks within 25 feet (7.5 meters) of openings. Building staff should be educated about this policy so they can direct smokers to designated smoking areas and away from entrances or windows. See Figure 1 in the LEED v4 reference guide.

Project Type Variations

Restaurant

Smoking must be prohibited outside the restaurant building in all areas except the designated outdoor smoking area. This prohibition must include all restaurant seating/café tables controlled by the project even if they lie outside of the property line (such as on a public sidewalk). See Figure 1 in the LEED v4 reference guide.

Required Documentation

Follow LEED v4 reference guide documentation requirements with the following modifications:

- ▶ Description of project's no smoking policy, addressing the expanded smoking definition in entirety and including information on how policy is communicated to building occupants and enforced for all projects where smoking is prohibited as well as for residential projects where smoking is permitted.
- ▶ Scaled site plan or map showing the location of all designated outdoor smoking and no-smoking areas, location of property line, and site boundary and indicating 25 foot distance from building openings or alternatively a copy of the local code regulations (translated in English with relevant sections highlighted) that are being met for non-smoking on the project in lieu of 25 feet rule.
- ▶ Drawings, photos, or other evidence of signage with language communicating no-smoking policy or evidence of any other means of enforcement (for example, evidence of enforcement by security personnel, educational pamphlets regarding building smoking policy or via digital displays available in lobby area etc.)
- ▶ Narrative of code restrictions being used in lieu of 25 feet rule from building openings for no smoking policy.

Connection to Ongoing Performance

- ▶ LEED O+M EQ prerequisite Environmental Tobacco Smoke Control: Strategies undertaken for minimizing exposure of building occupants to environmental tobacco smoke in a newly constructed building such as effective communication of the smoking policy for the building may help create precedence for prohibiting smoking in operations phase of the building and can contribute to better indoor environmental quality performance for the occupants during the operations phase.